



remote areas, especially in tribal dominated regions of the state, are being reached by the Mobile Medical Units (MMUs), which serve as self-contained clinics on wheels. The MMUs provide services like immunization, screening for diseases like malaria, pregnancy tests and family planning services, basic lab tests, X-rays, and minor surgical procedures. Each MMU has a staff strength of 5, including an MBBS doctor, nurse, pharmacist, lab tech, and driver. This empowering initiative is proving to be a boon in safeguarding and nurturing the health of the people enabling last mile connectivity with the help of MMUs.

Power Rich State

Chhattisgarh is endowed with rich natural resources which has empowered the young state, carved out on 1st November 2000, to become an energy surplus state within a short span of time supported by excellent power infrastructure. At the end of fiscal year 2022, the installed power capacity across Chhattisgarh was around 13,372 megawatts. Coal is the major source of energy that fires thermal power, in the mineral rich state. Among the leading hubs of thermal power generation in the state are the Korba West Extension thermal power plant (TPP) at Korba, and the Marwa TPP at Janjgir- Champa.

To make the power sector more reliable and robust, the conventional Chhattisgarh State Electricity Board has been reorganized into five companies namely, Chhattisgarh State Power Holding Company Limited, Chhattisgarh State Power Generation Company, Chhattisgarh State Power Transmission Company, Chhattisgarh State Power

Distribution Company and Chhattisgarh State Power Trading Company Limited. The state government also introduced many reforms to encourage private players to use the advantage of Chhattisgarh's strategic location to the fullest for setting up Captive power plants. It has allowed and facilitated third party sales to buyers from outside the State. In addition to the Chhattisgarh State Power Generation Company Limited (CSPGCL), electricity is also generated by Independent Power Producers (IPP) such as LANCO and Jindal Power. Over 87 percent of private sector power capacity and over 93 percent of state - owned power capacity are from coal-based power plants.

Chhattisgarh has also placed significant emphasis on renewable energy development as alternative to the depleting reserves of fossil fuel, which are polluting. The Chhattisgarh Renewable Energy Development Agency, is the special state nodal agency of Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE), Government of India, responsible for Development, Deployment, and

Promotion of Renewable Energy (RE). CREDA has been set-up to explore the various sources of alternative energy and augmenting their production. The State Electricity Regulatory Commission (SERC) has mandated renewable purchase obligations to promote RE Power generation, which has been declared as priority sector under state industrial policy. In a bid to further promote RE power, the Chhattisgarh government has announced state policies for promotion of solar, wind, hydro, and biomass power projects. Raipur, the capital of Chhattisgarh, is being developed as a 'Smart City' that will be fully run on solar power soon. Micro-Hydel power potential is also being tapped in a big way, and several projects have been identified for viable private investment. The Hasdeo Bango reservoir offers a relatively cheaper source of power generation.

Chhattisgarh has excellent potential for production of bio-fuel from tree borne oilseeds (TBOs), which is being explored as source of alternative fuel. A dedicated department, the Chhattisgarh Biofuel Development Authority" (CBDA) (CBDA) was set-up for promotion of bio-fuel through systematic, effective and coordinated management and monitoring of the activities connected with promotion of plantation, collection of seeds, extraction of bio-fuel and its marketing.

Also, the Chhattisgarh Environment Conservation Board (CECB) has been playing a key recommendatory and regulatory role in the state's power sector. CECB has taken steps to ensure that the state adopts super-critical technology for all new large power plants

